

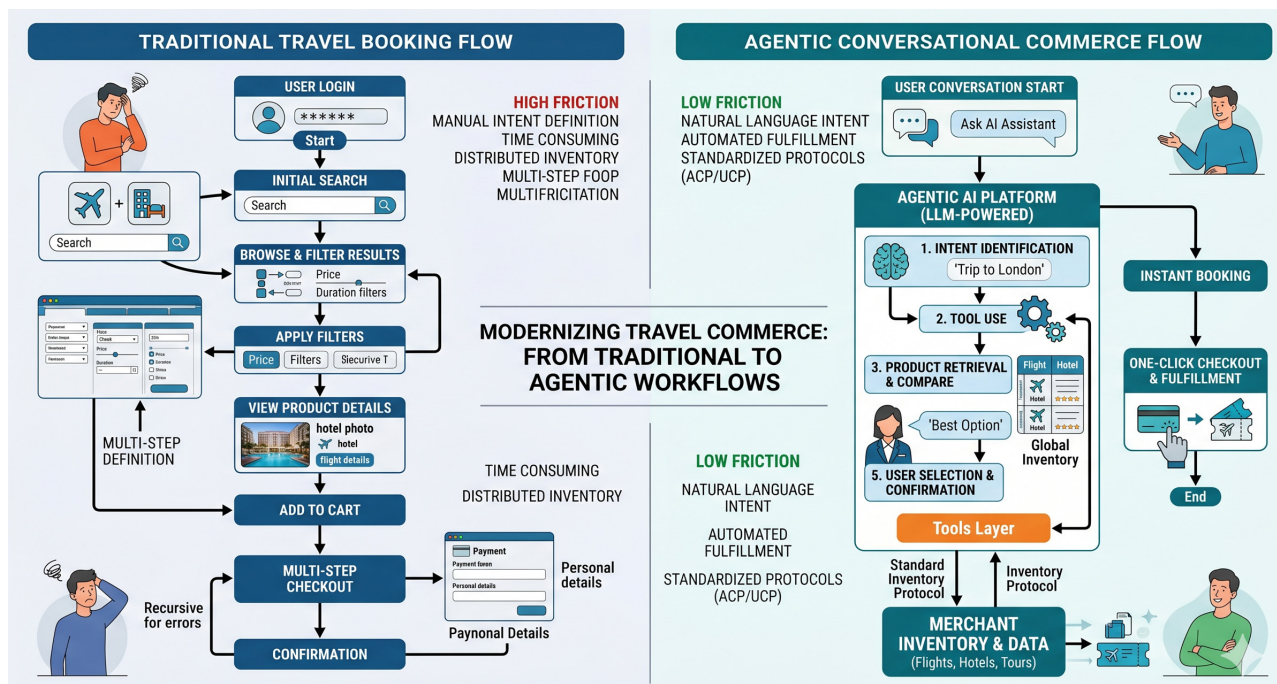


Figure 3: Conversational commerce for travel

hospitality sector, with conversational commerce, flights, hotels or tour packages become products. A user can instantly book the product from a conversational AI assistant itself.

Protocols: Standardisation for merchants

In a traditional commerce world, every platform has its own process for enabling merchants to list their product inventory. And there are different workflows for curating the inventory, supporting the shopping, and checkout. These different flows across platforms create a big overhead for the merchants — they need to spend time and resources whenever they want to integrate with a new platform. This forces them to limit their availability only to one or a few platforms.

Imagine a scenario where a single standardised protocol supports every platform. Merchants can just follow that standard protocol and their inventory will be seamlessly available across all the platforms that support it.

The world of conversational commerce is trying to address this challenge by introducing these standard

protocols in the agentic layer. Two major protocols have been proposed – OpenAI's Agentic Commerce Protocol (ACP) and Google's Universal Commerce Protocol (UCP). These open source protocols will enable merchants to be seamlessly available across a large ecosystem of conversational commerce platforms.

In the travel and hospitality sector, these protocols can help solve a major problem between distribution channels and suppliers. Typically, suppliers have their own mechanisms to distribute their inventory – be it flights, hotels or tour packages. To distribute that inventory across various channels like the Global Distribution System (GDS) is a major challenge. Suppliers and distribution platforms have to work together to make the supplier inventory available on those platforms. With standardised commerce protocols, this overhead is

eliminated. Suppliers become merchants and make their inventory available as per the protocol. This inventory can then be made available seamlessly across all conversational commerce platforms that support this protocol.

Conversational commerce is not just about adding an ML tool or an AI assistant to the existing commerce platforms. It will revolutionise the whole experience of commerce for users, with new players and platforms changing the entire shopping experience and the associated workflows. Organisations that can assess the impact this will have on their business and pivot to the new ecosystem will dominate the new conversational commerce space. **END** 🐧

References

- <https://www.agenticcommerce.dev/>
- <https://ucp.dev/>

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